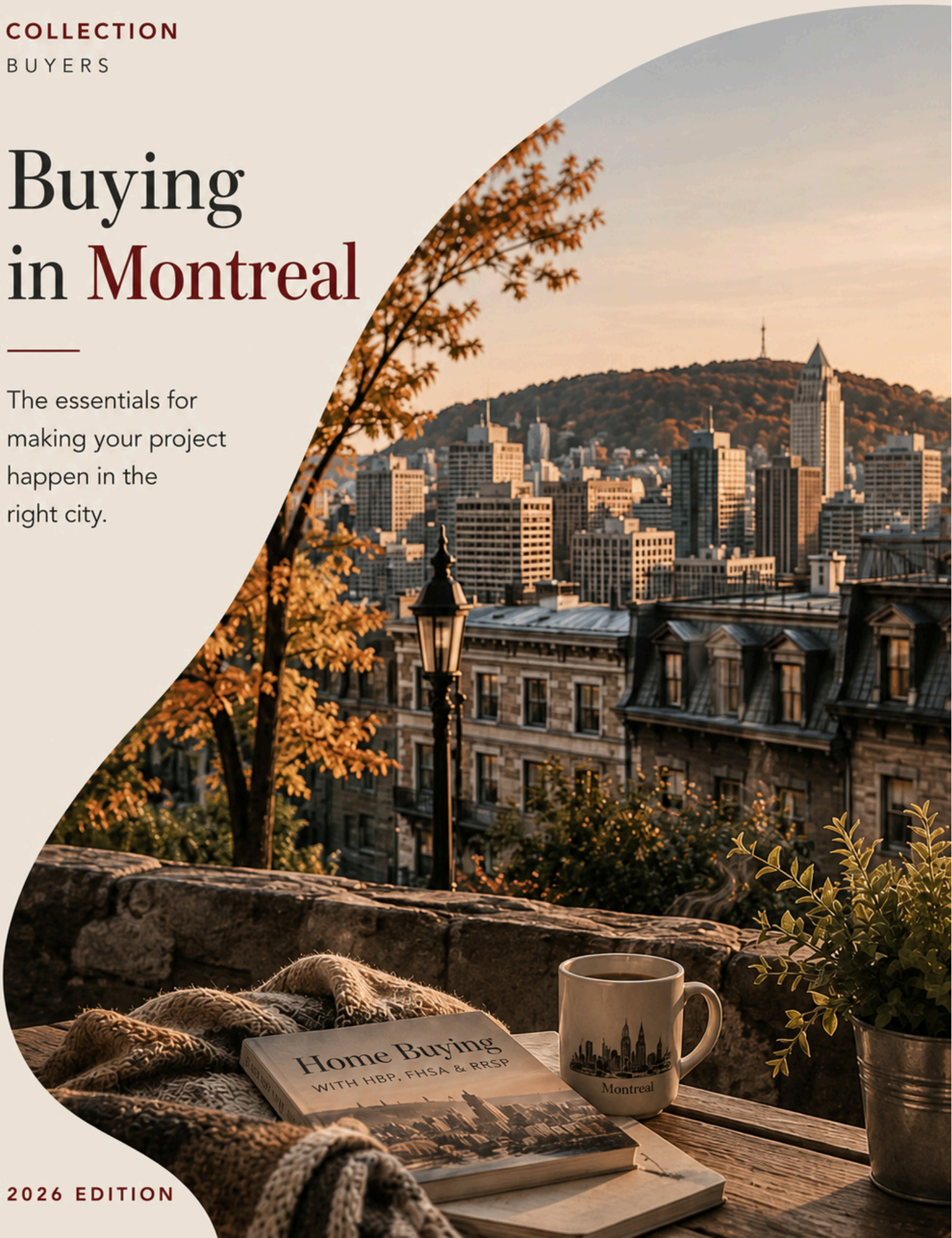
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Nº. 12

COLLECTION
BUYERS

Buying in Montreal

The essentials for making your project happen in the right city.



2026 EDITION

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Important notice

This guide is provided for informational and educational purposes only. It presents general information about real estate in Quebec and does not constitute personalized real estate, legal, tax or financial advice. Every real estate situation is different, and you should consult the appropriate professionals before making a decision about a transaction.

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Buying in Montréal · Collection Buyers · Guide No. 12 · 2026 Edition

COLLECTION BUYERS · GUIDE NO. 12

Buying in Montréal

The borough guide — finding your neighbourhood in the city

Montreal is a mosaic of neighborhoods with strong personalities: from the lively Plateau to the family-friendly areas of the west, from the charm of the South-West to the tranquility of Ahuntsic. Choosing your district is choosing a way of life.

This guide gives you a grid to compare the districts according to your priorities: transport, schools, atmosphere, type of building, price and resale potential.

Each chapter ends with a lined “My Notes” page to compare your favorite districts.

Montreal is a mosaic: the value, the atmosphere and the price change from one borough - and sometimes from one street - to another. This guide helps you decode Montreal logic, identify the family of sectors that suits you and buy with resale in mind.

Take the time to visit the targeted neighborhoods at different times: in Montreal more than elsewhere, the field tells the truth.

CHAPTER

Understanding Montreal logic

> *Enter what distinguishes one district from another.*

In Montreal, everything is played out at the scale of the neighborhood and even the street. Metro, schools, parks, commercial arteries, noise and buildings change radically in just a few street corners. The same budget buys very different realities depending on the district.

- Type of building: typical plexes, condos, single-family houses depending on the sector.
- Transport: proximity to the metro and major roads, cycle paths.
- Neighborhood life: commercial streets, parks, schools, atmosphere.

In Montreal, two properties at the same price, a few streets apart, can offer a very different quality of life: noise, parking, security, neighborhood life. This is why we don't buy "in Montreal" but in a specific sector, which we have to experience on site.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *In Montreal, never judge a district as a whole: walk the specific streets that interest you. Two blocks can change everything about price and ambiance.*

CHAPTER

The big families of districts

> *Find the sector style that suits you.*

- Central and lively (Plateau-Mont-Royal, Ville-Marie, Rosemont, Villeray): urban life, transport, plexes and condos, often high prices.
- In transformation / value (South-West, Hochelaga, Verdun): dynamism, projects, potential for added value, to be evaluated sector by sector.
- Family and established (Ahuntsic, NDG, Saint-Léonard, Rosemont east): schools, parks, relative calm.
- West and English-speaking areas (West Island: Pointe-Claire, Dollard, Kirkland): single-family homes, lots, suburban atmosphere in the city.

These groupings are benchmarks, not absolute truths: each district contains very different micro-neighborhoods.

Each large family of districts has its audience: central and lively for urban life, family sectors for space and schools, neighborhoods in transformation for potential. First identify your lifestyle, then target the districts that match it - this reduces the search enormously.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *If you are hesitating between "urban life" and "family space", this is often a sign that you need to clarify your lifestyle for the next 5 years before choosing the district.*

CHAPTER

Prices, taxes and Montreal particularities

> *Integrate costs and rules specific to the metropolis.*

Montreal applies higher bands of welcome tax for properties of higher value: the bill can quickly add up on an expensive purchase (see the dedicated guide). Plexes, which are very common, often involve existing tenants and leases to be taken over.

- Welcome tax: higher Montreal brackets on high amounts.
- Plex: leases and tenants follow the building.
- Parking, snow removal, permits: urban realities to consider.

Montreal adds higher welcome tax brackets for high-value properties: always have the amount estimated before offering. Add parking (vignette, scarcity), snow removal and the particularities of certain districts to your real cost calculation.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *On a high-value Montreal purchase, have the welcome tax estimated BEFORE offering: the City's upper brackets surprise many buyers.*

CHAPTER

Choose with resale in mind

> *Favor sectors with high sustainable demand.*

In Montreal, proximity to the metro, good schools and lively arteries sustainably supports value. Well-connected and sought-after areas resell faster, even when the market slows down.

Beware of nuisances that are difficult to change (motorway, railway, noise) which weigh on resale, even at a good purchase price.

In Montreal, proximity to the metro, good schools and lively arteries supports value over time. A sought-after sector sells better and resists slowdowns: buy with the next buyer in mind, even if you plan to stay for a long time.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *The metro is a value magnet in Montreal. For the same budget, a well-served area will protect you better on resale than a landlocked area.*

CHAPTER

The Montreal real estate portfolio: plexes and condos

> *Understand typical property types.*

Montreal has a particular real estate portfolio, marked by **plex** (duplex, triplex) and **condos**, more than by the single-family house.

- **Plex** : possibility of living in one accommodation and renting others, but tenant management and rental rules to be aware of.
- **Condo** : entry level more accessible in town, but charges and co-ownership life.
- **Single-family** : rarer and more expensive in the central sectors.

The right choice depends on your budget, your tolerance for management and your lifestyle.

A plex can be a great springboard (you live and the rent reduces the mortgage), but you become owner-lessor, with leases and obligations. The condo offers a more accessible entry level in the city, at the price of charges and co-ownership life to be accepted.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *In Montreal, a plex can be a great springboard: you live there and the rent reduces your mortgage. But you become an owner-lessor: find out about your obligations before you start.*

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

> *Your next steps, concretely.*

This week

1. List my 3 candidate districts and my type of building.
2. Walk the specific targeted streets, at different times.

Within 30 days

1. Compare prices, welcome tax and transport for each sector.
2. Check schools, plexes/tenants and possible nuisances.

Then

1. Have Emilie analyze the resale dynamics of my target districts.

To target my sector

1. Define my priority lifestyle, then 2-3 target districts.
2. Visit at different times and estimate my welcome fee before bidding.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- District: administrative division of Montreal, with its own personality.
- Plex: building of 2 to 4 apartments, very present in Montreal.
- Higher brackets: higher levels of welcome tax in Montreal.
- West Island: western sectors, largely English-speaking.
- Structural transport: metro and major routes that support value.

- District: administrative division of Montreal, with its own rules and taxes.
- Plex: duplex/triplex, common in Montreal, to occupy and/or rent.
- Upper brackets: welcome tax levels specific to the mainland.
- Parking sticker: street parking permit by sector.
- Resale potential: lasting appeal that protects value.

GO FURTHER

Quiz - test yourself

1. In Montreal, the scale that matters is:

A) The province

B) The neighborhood and even the street

C) The country

D) The continent

2. The Plateau, Villeray, Rosemont are rather:

A) Rural

B) Central and lively

C) Without transportation

D) Industrial

3. The West Island is characterized by:

A) Only tricks

B) Single-family homes, land, suburban atmosphere and strong English-speaking presence

C) No school

D) No cars

4. The welcome tax in Montreal:

A) Does not exist

B) Has higher upper brackets

C) Is fixed at $100

D) Is paid by the seller

5. Buying a Montreal plex often involves:

A) No tenant

B) Leases and tenants to be taken over

C) Zero maintenance

D) A tax exemption

6. What sustainably supports value in Montreal:

A) Distance

B) Proximity to the metro, schools and busy arteries

C) Noise

D) Lack of services

7. Before offering on an expensive purchase, you must:

A) Ignore taxes

B) Estimate the Montreal welcome tax

C) Pay cash

D) Wait for winter

8. The groupings of districts are:

A) Absolute truths

B) Benchmarks, each sector having micro-districts

C) Without interest

D) Fixed by law

Answers

1. B - Everything changes from one street to another (chap. 1).

2. B - Urban life, transportation, plexes and condos (chap. 2).

3. B - Suburb in the city (chap. 2).

4. B - Upper bearings on high uprights (chapter 3).

5. B - Leases follow the building (chap. 3).

6. B - Connectivity and services (chap. 4).

7. B - The upper sections surprise (chap. 3).

8. B - Benchmarks, not absolutes (chap. 2).

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You now have the right keys in hand.

Every real estate journey is different.

If you would like to go further,
I would be happy to discuss
your project with you.



Make informed decisions.
Choose with confidence.
Live without regrets.
See you soon,
Emilie ☺

Emilie Cauvier

RESIDENTIAL & COMMERCIAL
REAL ESTATE BROKER

(514) 774-9818

emilie@equipecauvier.com

guidesimmoquebec.com